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El Paso Herald-Post (El Paso, Texas) · Wed, Jun 5, 1968 · Page 33
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El Paso Herald-Post

Masterful Three-Hitter Snaps Shutout Records

Drysdale Gets as Much Acclaim as Koufax

By ALEX KAHN
UPI Sports Writer

LOS ANGELES, June 5. — During the many years Don Drysdale was a teammate of the great Sandy Koufax he became accustomed to hearing the crowd give the lefthanded pitcher thunderous ovations.

And now that he is receiving the plaudits of the crowds, Drysdale hardly knows how to react and he said today he was thrilled by the applause and cheers he has been receiving from the fans.

KOUFAX IN his finest moments was not greeted with more acclaim than Drysdale received last night when he set a major league record and a National League mark while hurling his sixth straight shutout win of the season.

Drysdale with his 5-0 victory over the Pittsburgh Pirates broke the major league mark for consecutive shutouts and at the same time he set a new National League mark of 54 consective scoreleless innings. That shattered the record of 46 1-3 set by Carl Hubbell of the old New York Giants in 1933 and was just two innings short of Walter Johnson's record of 56 straight scoreless innings set in 1913.

"I can't recall ever getting a hand like the crowd gave me even when I was warming up," Drysdale said. "That was the first time the crowd was so strong behind me."

THE CONSECUTIVE shutout streak broke the record set long before the 31-year-old Drysdale was born by Guy (Doc) White back in 1904 with the Chicago White Sox. And Hubbell set his record of consecutive shutout innings three years before Drysdale's birth.

Manager Walter Alston joined the crowd of 30,422 in cheering and praising Drysdale's performance.

"Drysdale gets better as the years get along," Alston said. "I thought his shutout over the San Francisco Giants last Friday was the best effort of the season, but his win last night over Pittsburgh was even better. He didn't throw as many pitches and gave up only three hits and was in command all the way."

ALSTON REVEALED that he also gambled a little to preserve Drysdale's shutout. With the speedy Maury Wills on first base in the ninth inning, the normal procedure would have been for the first baseman to play back and if necessary give up a run with a 5-0 lead.

"I decided to have the first baseman hold Wills on the bag by playing up," Alston said. "It was a gamble but I felt Drysale deserved the chance to keep his shutout."

But the efficient Paul Popovich at second base removed any fears by throwing out Willie Stargell to end the game.

IN HURLING his sixth straight shutout, Drysale said he used the same pitches he has been employing all along but he credited the Dodgers' tight defense with making it possible and singled out Popovich for a special measure of praise.

Catcher Tom Haller, however, said that yesterday was one of Drysdale's best nights of the season on the mound.

"He used mainly sliders and fast balls and threw only two change of pace pitches," Haller said. "It was an outstanding performance that may not be equalled for a long time.

The Dodgers go back to more normal conditions tonight when they again meet the Pirates with Bill Singer, 4-5, opposing Al McBean, 5-4.

★ ★ ★

Drysdale Helped By Paul Popovich

By VITO STELLINO
UPI Sports Writer

Don Drysdale didn't need any help from Harry Wendelstedt this time but he got quite an assist from Paul Popovich.

Drysdale set a major league record last night by pitching his sixth straight shutout and set a National League mark by stretching his streak of consecutive scoreless innings to 54. He's only two shy of the major league mark of 56 set by Walter Johnson in 1913.

THE BIG righthander accomplished all this by tossing a three-hit shutout at the Pittsburgh Pirates while pitching the Los Angeles Dodgers to a 5-0 victory.

Behind the plate again was umpire Harry Wendelstedt but this time he wasn't involved in a controversy. It was Wendelstedt who made the decision last Friday night that preserved the streak when he called back San Francisco's Dick Dietz for not trying to avoid the pitch after Drysdale hit him with the bases loaded in the ninth inning.

BUT POPOVICH, the second baseman who was obtained from the Cubs in the Lou Johnson deal this winter, was invaluable as he made several sparkling plays.

The biggest came with two out in the sixth when Maury Wills hit a slow roller with Gary Kolb, who had doubled and gone to third on an infield out, on third base. Popovich charged the ball and flipped to first to just nipped the dashing Wills.

Popovich also went behind the bat at second to scoop up Roberto Clemente's hard grounder and he tossed out Willie Stargell for the last out of the game after Wills singled with two out in the ninth.

ELSEWHERE in the National League, Philadelphia topped San Francisco 5-1, St. Louis nipped Houston 3-2, Cincinnati topped Atlanta 3-1 and New York blanked Chicago 5-0.

The streaking St. Louis Cardinals chalked up their seventh straight victory by downing Houston. Julian Javier singled in the deciding run with two out in the ninth, scoring Lou Brock who singled and stole second.

Rookie Jerry Koosman became the Majors' second nine-game winner as he pitched an eight-hit shutout to lift New York past Chicago.

Larry Jackson pitched a four-hitter and John Callison hit a two-run homer in the first as Philadelphia topped San Francisco.

Tony Perez singled home the tie-breaking run in a two-run sixth inning to give the Reds the triumph over the Braves.

HAPPY FOR DON—Don Drysdale is mobbed by happy teammates after he set two baseball records by hurling his sixth straight shutout last night. He beat the Pittsburgh Pirates 5-0. (UPI)

Hurls Kings Over Amarillo—

Murphy's Bat And Mates Share Light

Special To The Herald-Post

AMARILLO, June 5. — Andy Cohen, who made his debut as temporary manager of the El Paso Sun Kings a winning one, today didn't know what to praise most: 1) Tom Murphy's pitching, 2) Tom Murphy's hitting, or 3) Tom Murphy's teammates.

Murphy pitched and batted the Kings to an 8-5 victory over Amarillo here last night.

"HE WAS a little wild and got into trouble right away," Cohen said, "but he was tougher than nails when he had to get key men out.

"And how about his hitting? He hit two homers and two singles. He struck out his other time at bat, but we forgave him."

COHEN SAID the Kings played a "great game" behind Murphy. "Marty (shortstop Marty Perez) made a beautiful play to get Murphy out of one jam. And there were other good plays during the game.

"Murphy got a little tired in the eight, so we brought in Steve Kealy. Steve mowed 'em down in the ninth."

THE VICTORY moved El Paso to within 2½ games of the idle Albuquerque Dodgers. A doubleheader between the Dodgers and San Antonio Missions was postponed because of rain.

Both the Sun Kings and Dodgers will be involved in doubleheaders tonight, the Sun Kings with Amarillo and the Dodgers with San Antonio.

Cohen's ranks may be a bit thin today. Catcher Dennis Paepke and second baseman Gordy Avery both sprained ankles last night. Paepke had to leave the game last night.

Cohen isn't sure whether they'll play tonight. Bill Bethea will move to second and John Olerud will catch if need be.

Hurling for the Kings will be Vern Geishert and Rudy May.

MURPHY, who hit the lead-off batter then walked the next one, gave up three runs in the first inning. He got those back with a two-run homer in the second and a solo clout in the sixth. He had four RBI's all told. Jim DeNeff also homered for El Paso.

IN OTHER ACTION yesterday, the Arkansas Travelers pounded the Dallas - Fort Worth Spurs 9-2 and the Shreveport Braves beat the Memphis Blues 5-4.

EL PASO	ab	r	h	rbi	AMARILLO	ab	r	h	rbi
Avery 2b	5	1	2	1	Rosario cf	3	1	1	0
J. Tatum cf	6	0	1	1	Marsden rf	5	1	1	0
Spencer 1b	6	0	1	0	Ferro 2b	3	1	0	0
Wilkinson rf	5	0	2	1	Taylor lf	2	2	2	2
Paepke c	2	0	0	0	Gallagher 3b	3	0	1	1
Olerud pr-c	0	0	0	0	Mallon 1b	4	0	1	1
Perez ss	5	0	1	0	Morales c	3	0	0	0
Denoff lf	3	1	1	1	Blanco ss	4	0	0	0
Silveria ph-lf	0	0	0	0	Bryant p	2	0	0	0
Bethea 3b	3	3	2	0	Corkins p	0	0	0	0
Murphy p	5	2	4	3	Engberg ph	1	0	0	0
May pr	0	1	0	0	Quimby p	0	0	0	0
Kealy p	0	0	0	0	Pollock p	0	0	0	0
					Soares ph	1	0	0	0
Totals	40	8	14	7	Totals	31	5	6	4

EL PASO .... 020 201 012—8
AMARILLO .... 300 001 100—5
E—Paepke, Morales, Rosario.
DP—Murphy to Perez to Spencer; Blanco to Ferro to Mallon.
LOB—El Paso 14, Amarillo 6.
2B—Bethea, Spencer, Taylor.
HR—Murphy 2 (1-2); DeNeff (8).
SB—Marsden 2; Rosario, Bethea.
SF—Avery.

	ip	h	r	er	bb	so
Murphy (W 2-0)	8	6	5	4	6	2
Bryant	4⅓	7	4	4	4	4
Corkins	2⅔	2	1	1	2	4
Quimby (L 0-2)	1⅓	4	3	3	2	1
Pollock	⅔	1	0	0	0	1

HBP—Rosario (Murphy).
WP—Murphy, Corkins, Quimby.
Umpires—Avants and Henrion.
Time—3:15.
Attendance—746.

ARKANSAS .... 000 020 141—8 12 1
DALLAS-FW .... 001 001 000—2 7 1
Martin, Whitlock (7), Hilgendorf (7) and Roberts; Gerberman, Doyle (5), Woods (8), Shrowder (8) and Howard. HR—Christino (Ark.) 9th, none on. WP—Martin. LP—Doyle.

MEMPHIS .... 102 010 000—4 5 1
SHREVEPORT .... 102 200 00x—5 11 3
Folkers, Bethke (4), Musgroves (7) and Flodin; Martin and Turzwill. WP—Martin. LP—Folkers.
Albuquerque at Arkansas doubleheader postponed rain.

By the Way . . .

S.W. Racing Loses One of Top Men

By RAY SANCHEZ

Ivan Thomas, the late Centennial Race Track general manager, was one of the most highly regarded racing men in the Southwest. News of his death was received with shock and sorrow in El Paso, where he was well known and well thought of.

"Not only was he a good friend, but he was a big help to me," Bob Haynsworth, Sunland Park general manager, says. "When I first started in this business, I would ask him questions. He was always willing to help."

Good Man Handy

CENTENNIAL was lucky to have a good man handy to step into the job. R. Wood (Woody) Erwin had moved to Denver only last April. He has vast experience, having been general manager at Sunland Park and La Mesa Park.

Erwin, born in Boonshill, Tenn., in 1915 as one of six brothers, moved to Raton, N.M., in 1944 and opened an office there as public accountant.

He soon got involved with La Mesa Park and closed his accountant's office.

He became general manager at Sunland when it opened in 1959 and was there until 1963 when La Mesa Park beckoned. He had roots there and saw a good future for the "friendly track," so he made the move.

His easy-going, smooth approach to the difficult duties of a race track g.m. proved highly successful at Sunland and La Mesa.

One of his sons, William C., is attending University of Denver Law School.

(Incidentally, Art Johnson, comptroller and assistant general manager at Sunland Park, was among those mentioned as a possible successor to Thomas.)

Sees Good Sunland Future

FROM WARREN EVES, former director of publicity at Sunland Park and holding a similar position at Centennial Race Track:

"I want to take this opportunity to thank you and your staffers for the nice way you treated me in El Paso.

"I'm sure El Paso is in for two of its biggest years of racing under the light . . .

"It was a pleasure working with Sunland Park's fine staff . . . I'll always be a booster of Sunland because I still feel strongly that the plant will make it in a big way . . ."

Car Racing Has Arrived

FROM ALTON FLOWERS, one of the Southwest's leading car drivers:

". . . Car racing has really come to El Paso, which is long overdue, which is in most cases the fault of the management and poor publicity of our home town paper. There are from three to four thousand people going to Horizon Speedway every Saturday night to watch the $5000 Super Modified race cars race around a ⅜ mile track for a guaranteed purse of $1000 and the stock cars for a guaranteed purse of $400. Super modified racers come from Albuquerque every Saturday to compete . . . This is the biggest and most exciting sport that El Paso has ever offered.

". . . I feel that if you and your paper would support car racing as you do baseball and horse racing, El Paso someday would have a NASCAR racing track.

". . . I have been racing in El Paso and Las Cruces for 13 years, so I do know what I am talking about. Racing and cars have improved tremendously in the last two years. At the close of the racing season in 1966, there was only one track (in Anapra, New Mexico) for El Paso and Las Cruces cars to run on. This past year, Horizon Speedway was built, and this year Las Cruces has its own race track, and enough cars built to put on good races for the spectators at each . . ."

Thompson Replaces Bavasi

United Press International

LOS ANGELES, June 5. — Fresco Thompson, veteran executive of the Los Angeles Dodgers, was named the club's general manager yesterday, replacing E. J. (Buzzie) Bavasi, who leaves to become part owner of the new San Diego expansion club.

Thompson was named to the post by Dodgers president Walter F. O'Malley. Thompson is in New York representing the club at the important free agency draft meeting this week and will return to Los Angeles Friday to assume his new tasks.

Thompson, who will be 65 this month, has been in professional baseball for 45 years, since he joined the Grand Island, Neb., team in 1923 as an infielder.

BASEBALL STANDINGS

TEXAS LEAGUE
Eastern Division

	W.	L.	Pct.	GB
Arkansas	24	21	.533	—
Shreveport	24	24	.500	1½
Memphis	21	25	.457	2½
Dallas-FW	21	29	.420	5½

Western Division

	W.	L.	Pct.	GB
Albuquerque	29	15	.659	—
El Paso	**28**	**19**	**.596**	**2½**
San Antonio	18	24	.429	10
Amarillo	18	26	.409	11

YESTERDAY'S RESULTS
El Paso 8, Amarillo 5.
Arkansas 8, Dallas-FW 2.
Shreveport 5, Memphis 4.
Albuquerque at San Antonio (2) ppd., rain.

SCHEDULE TONIGHT
El Paso at Amarillo.
Arkansas at Dallas-FW.
Memphis at Shreveport.
Albuquerque at Sna Antonio.

AMERICAN LEAGUE

	W.	L.	Pct.	GB
Detroit	31	19	.620	—
Baltimore	28	21	.571	2½
Cleveland	29	22	.569	2½
Minnesota	26	24	.520	5
Boston	25	25	.500	6
Oakland	23	25	.479	7
California	23	28	.451	8½
New York	22	28	.440	9
Chicago	21	27	.438	9
Washington	20	29	.408	10½

YESTERDAY'S RESULTS
Boston 2, Detroit 0.
Detroit 2, Boston 0.
Cleveland 2, Chicago 1.
Washington 4, Oakland 2.
California 5, Baltimore 3 (10 innings).
Minnesota 3, New York 0.

NATIONAL LEAGUE

	W.	L.	Pct.	GB
St. Louis	29	21	.580	—
Atlanta	27	23	.540	2
Philadelphia	24	21	.533	2½
San Francisco	27	24	.529	2½
Chicago	25	24	.510	3½
Los Angeles	27	26	.509	3½
Cincinnati	24	24	.500	4
New York	21	27	.438	7
Houston	21	28	.429	7½
Pittsburgh	19	26	.422	7½

YESTERDAY'S RESULTS
New York 5, Chicago 0.
Cincinnati 3, Atlanta 1.
St. Louis 3, Houston 2.
Los Angeles 5, Pittsburgh 0.
Philadelphia 5, San Francisco 1.

GAMES TODAY
American League
Chicago (Carlos 2-5) at Cleveland (Williams 3-3) night.
Oakland (Pierce 1-1) at Washington (Pascual 4-3) night.
California (Brunet 5-5) at Baltimore (Brabender 4-2) night.
Minnesota (Chance 4-6) at New York (Stottlemyre 6-4) night.
Detroit (Cain 1-0) at Boston (Culp 2-2) night.

National League
New York (Seaver 2-5) at Chicago (Niekro 5-4).
Atlanta (Niekro 5-3) at Cincinnati (Nolan 1-0) night.
Philadelphia (Fryman 7-4) at San Francisco (Perry 6-2).
St. Louis (Jaster 3-2) at Houston (Dierker 5-7) night.
Pittsburgh (McBean 5-4) at Los Angeles (Singer 4-5) night.

PACIFIC COAST LEAGUE
Denver 4, Tulsa 3.
Vancouver 3, Indianapolis 0.
Oklahoma City 5, Spokane 4.
Phoenix 2, Seattle 1.
Portland 4, Hawaii 1.
San Diego 11, Tacoma 1.

Epstein 'Comes Back'

By GARY KALE
UPI Sports Writer

Scholarly Mike Epstein finally fulfilled his favorite Shakespearean soliloquy which begins "tomorrow and tomorrow and tomorrow. . ."

Epstein promised he'd be back "tomorrow" when Washington sent the strapping first baseman down to Buffalo to find his batting eye. His vision was perfect in a brief International League stint as he batted .400, hit five homers and drove in 13 runs.

THE CONTROVERSIAL Epstein was traded to the Senators by Baltimore last season because he refused to accept a minor league demotion. This time he went willingly and vowed he'd be back soon.

Washington recalled him when manager Jim Lemon felt the hitting pinch as the club went through a dismal May with only six victories in 27 games. His presence was felt immediately when he hit a two-run homer in his first game back last night to power the Senators to a 4-2 victory over the Oakland athletics.

Epstein, batting .099 when he was optioned to Buffalo, broke a 2-2 tie with his homer in the sixth inning. The drive carried over the 350-foot mark in right field at the D. C. stadium in Washington.

"I can't explain the hitting change," Epstein shrugged. "I really don't know of anything different I'm doing now except that the hits are dropping in."

DETROIT increased its American League lead to 2½ games by beating Boston 2-0 after dropping a 2-0 twi-night twin-bill opener to the Red Sox, Cleveland edged Chicago 2-1, California clipped Baltimore 5-3 in 10 innings and Minnesota shut out New York 3-0.

George Scott's two-run double with the bases loaded in the sixth inning of the opener broke up Detroit starter Mickey Lolich's no-hit bid.

Luis Taint pitched a four-hitter and won his eighth game for Cleveland when Larry Brown hit a sacrifice fly with the bases loaded and none out in the eighth inning.

CALIFORNIA defeated Baltimore when pinchhitter Tom Satriano singled home two runs in the 10th inning after the Angels loaded the bases.

Harmon Killebrew drove in a pair of runs with two sacrifice flies and Tony Oliva sent in a third run in similar fashion for Minnesota as Jim Merritt tossed his first shutout of the season.

How Kings Are Hitting

	AB	R	H	RBI	HR	AVG
Bethea	65	14	23	9	3	.354
J. Tatum	81	6	27	9	2	.333
Spencer	176	35	57	44	15	.324
Paepke	54	7	16	12	3	.296
Olerud	95	11	28	7	2	.295
Silverio	116	23	34	14	2	.293
Avery	122	22	32	12	3	.262
Perez	138	24	36	18	1	.261
Wilkinson	148	23	38	31	5	.257
DeNeff	153	29	36	19	2	.235
Stubing	34	2	8	6	1	.235

PITCHING
Boehlert 4-1; Sennett 2-0; Murphy 2-0; Lervig 2-1; K. Tatum 1-1; Geishert 4-5; Holbrook 1-3; Overton 2-2; May 3-3.

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